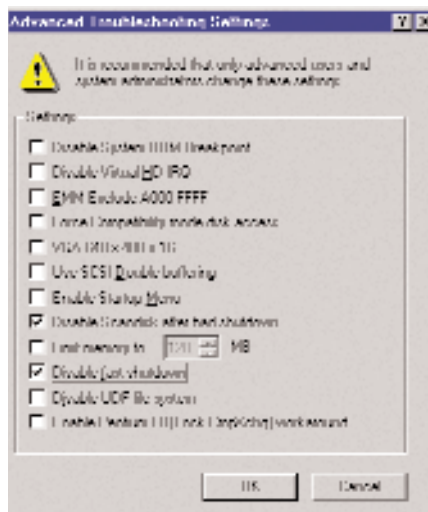




Disable fast shutdown using msconfig

To solve the problem, you can download the Windows IDE Hard Drive Cache package from the Windows Update Web site (<http://windowsupdate.microsoft.com>). Another way to solve this problem is to disable the Fast Shutdown feature.

To do this, run regedit and navigate to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\System\CurrentControlSet\Control\Shutdown. Change the value of FastReboot to 0.

With Windows 98, you can change this from the Microsoft System Configuration Utility (msconfig.exe), instead of modify-

ing the registry. Click on the Advanced button under the General tab and check the box labelled Disable Fast Shutdown. Alternatively, you may also check the box next to Disable Scandisk after bad shutdown.

Another reason for Scandisk to run at every reboot can be because of the Autoscan entry in msdos.sys. This file is located in the root of the boot partition and controls Windows settings before Windows loads.

If the value of Autoscan is 1, it will run every time. If it is 0, it will never run automatically on startup and if it is 2, it will run only on improper shutdowns.

Hence, if none of the solutions can prevent it from running, you can simply set its value to 0. To edit the file, you will first need to strip its attributes by using `attrib -h -r -s c:\msdos.sys` at the command prompt and then open the file in notepad and change the values.

Remember to change the attributes back to the original after you are done with the change.

Internet & Communication

+ The Hotmail Xperience

I have a Hotmail account for quite some years, and recently I installed Microsoft XP 2000 for supporting Hotmail in Outlook. Now, with Outlook XP, when I click on Send/Receive, it starts

the Sending Outbox and Inbox synchronisation process, but after some time I get an error, 'Reported error (0x800ccc19): A timeout occurred while connecting with the server.' Also, on some occasions, a new message does appear in the Outlook Inbox, but when I try to open it, I get an error message saying that I cannot open this item, and that I need to connect to the server to complete the action. Help solve this problem.

Dilip Awari

Via e-mail

R This is not a problem with Outlook. Since you have mentioned that the Hotmail account used to work well under Outlook earlier, it is doubtful that any of the settings would be wrong.

The problem is usually just due to a bad Internet connection—Hotmail takes quite long to validate users and synchronise folders. There's not much you can do about this until your connection speeds improve.

Linux

+ The partition divide

On my 60 GB HDD, with Windows 98, I installed RedHat Linux 7.1 on a dedicated partition, while installing LiLo as mentioned in one of your articles on multiple operating systems. But instead of choosing not to install LiLo in the MBR, I installed it in the MBR.

Hardware

Filled to the brim

I had a Cyrix 233 MMX processor system on a Zida/Tomato TX-98 motherboard. Since the old hard disk developed bad sectors, I replaced it with a 20 GB hard disk (Seagate) last year. When it was formatted and partitioned I could only use 8 GB of this disk.

Last month I upgraded the CPU to AMD Duron 750 MHz, on a DFI AK 74 SC motherboard, but I am using the same hard disk. Since I have not reformatted the disk, only 8 GB capacity is usable, but I want to use the full 20 GB capacity. How can I do this without losing any data or system files?

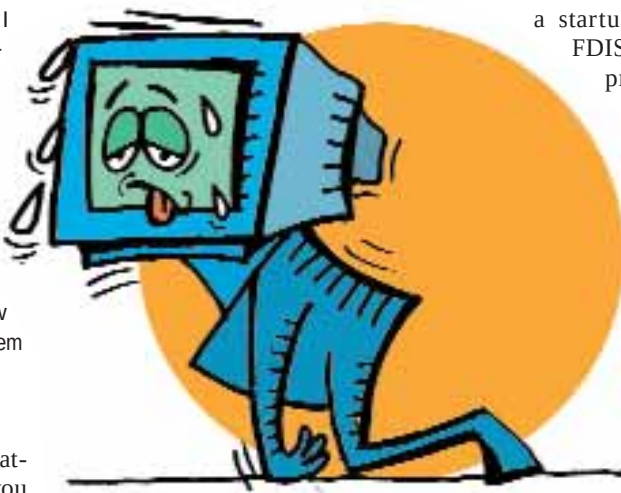
Francisco

Via e-mail

You haven't mentioned which operating system is installed on the PC. If you are using one older than Windows 95 SR2, you will not be able to use more than 8 GB of the disk.

First, ensure that the hard disk is cor-

rectly configured in the BIOS. To do this, press the [DEL] key when you start the machine (in some BIOS the key is dif-



ferent and is indicated on screen). Check Standard CMOS Setup and ensure that the hard disk is recognised as a 20 GB

one or as Auto. If it is and you have Windows 95 SR2 or higher, boot to DOS. If you don't already have a compatible OS installed, you can boot to DOS using a startup disk made from one. Run FDISK (type `fdisk` at the command prompt).

You will be asked whether you want to enable large disk support. Enter Y and create an extended partition, followed by a logical drive.

This way, you will not lose any data. If you already have an extended partition, you will not be able to create another.

You will have to delete and recreate the partition or use other third-party utilities such as Partition Magic

(www.powerquest.com).

Note: For Windows 2000, you may need to install additional drivers, depending on your disk make and type.